

Daily Bible Note

Date: June 13, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Corinthians 15:12-19

12 Now if Christ is preached that He has been raised from the dead, how do some among you say that there is no resurrection of the dead?

13 But if there is no resurrection of the dead, then Christ is not risen.

14 And if Christ is not risen, then our preaching is empty and your faith is also empty.

15 Yes, and we are found false witnesses of God, because we have testified of God that He raised up Christ, whom He did not raise up—if in fact the dead do not rise.

16 For if the dead do not rise, then Christ is not risen.

17 And if Christ is not risen, your faith is futile; you are still in your sins!

18 Then also those who have fallen asleep in Christ have perished.

19 If in this life only we have hope in Christ, we are of all men the most pitiable.

II. Key Summary

- Paul confronts those in the Corinthian church who deny the resurrection of the dead, even though they still accept Christ's own resurrection
 - Paul walks through a chain of "if...then" logic to show the consequences if Christ has not risen: preaching is empty, faith is empty, the apostles are false witnesses, believers are still in their sins, and those who died in Christ have perished forever
 - Paul concludes in verse 19 that if Christians have hope only for this life, they are more pitiable than anyone else
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III. Passage Analysis

The Corinthians Misunderstood What "Resurrection" Meant

"The Corinthian Christians did not deny Jesus' resurrection; they denied our resurrection. They were influenced by Greek philosophy, which considered the resurrection undesirable — thinking that existing as a 'pure spirit' after death was a superior state to bodily resurrection." [1]

The problem wasn't that people doubted Jesus rose — it was that they thought becoming a "pure spirit" after death was better than bodily resurrection. Paul's response cuts through that: if you deny that resurrection can happen at all, you've already denied Christ's resurrection too. You can't have it both ways.

Without the Resurrection, Faith Has No Foundation

"If Christ remained dead, redemption never occurred, making Christian proclamation fundamentally false and faith utterly groundless." [2]

Paul doesn't soften this: if the resurrection didn't happen, Christian faith isn't just unhelpful — it's completely without ground. He doesn't offer "well, the feelings you experienced were still real." His question is simpler and sharper: did this actually happen, or not?

IV. Reflection Question

When you believe something, what's your main reason — does it just feel right, or do you actually think it's true?

Paul says he believed in the resurrection because it really happened — not because it made him feel better. He called that reality the whole foundation of his faith.

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik Commentary,
<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-corinthians-15/>

[2] BibleHub.com, Multiple Commentaries,
https://www.biblehub.com/commentaries/1_corinthians/15-14.htm